

BRAINSTORMING & IDEATION PHASE

Project Title

A CRM APPLICATION FOR THE CHAI SHOP & CO

1. Introduction

The Brainstorming and Ideation Phase is the first stage of the project. In this phase, the main business problem is identified, the needs of the users are understood, and possible solutions are discussed.

For **The Chai Shop & Co**, the project focuses on developing a **Salesforce-based Customer Relationship Management (CRM) application**. The system is designed to manage customer relationships, employer information, enterprise accounts, sales activities, billing, reports, dashboards, and customer communication.

2. Project Idea

Topic: Project Idea

The main idea of the project is to develop a centralized CRM application using Salesforce for **The Chai Shop & Co**.

The application helps the organization maintain customer and business information in a structured way. It also supports sales process automation, billing calculations, report generation, dashboards, and customer communication.

The proposed CRM system reduces manual work and helps users manage customer relationships more efficiently.

3. Problem Identification

Topic: Problem Identification

The project identifies several problems in the existing customer and sales management process.

Major Problems

- Manual management of customer records.
- Difficulty in maintaining accurate customer information.
- Errors in sales and billing calculations.
- Delays in generating reports.
- Difficulty in managing employer and enterprise information.
- Possibility of data loss or duplication.
- Limited automation in customer communication.
- Difficulty in tracking customer-related activities.

These problems create additional work for sales representatives and managers and can affect the efficiency of business operations.

4. Target Users

Topic: Target Users

The CRM application is designed for different users involved in customer and business management.

Target Users

User	Purpose
Sales Representatives	Manage customer information and sales activities
Managers	Monitor business activities and reports
System Administrators	Manage the Salesforce system and users

Business Analysts Analyze customer and sales information

The project document identifies these users as the main target users of the system.

5. Empathy Analysis

Topic: Understanding User Needs

The empathy analysis focuses on understanding the problems faced by users while managing customer and sales information.

User Pain Points

- Manual work takes more time.
- Data entry can result in errors.
- Reports may take time to prepare.
- Customer information may be difficult to manage.
- Lack of automation can create delays.
- Managing large amounts of customer data can be difficult.

Expected Gains

The users expect:

- Automated processes.
- Faster access to information.
- Accurate data management.
- Easy report generation.
- Better customer relationship management.
- Improved operational efficiency.

These pain points and expected gains are reflected in the project's empathy analysis.

6. Brainstorming Ideas

Topic: Possible Solutions

During the brainstorming stage, different approaches were considered for managing customer information and business activities.

The project document identifies the following ideas:

1. Manual CRM Management

- a. Customer information can be managed manually.
- b. This approach requires more human effort.

2. Excel-Based Management

- a. Customer and sales data can be stored in Excel files.
- b. Data management and reporting can become difficult as the amount of information increases.

3. Web-Based CRM

- a. A centralized web-based CRM can be used to manage customer information.
- b. Automation can be added for sales, billing, reports, and communication.

The brainstorming process resulted in the selection of a CRM-based approach for the project.

7. Proposed Solution

Topic: Proposed CRM Solution

The proposed solution is a **Salesforce-based CRM application** for The Chai Shop & Co.

The system provides a centralized platform to manage:

- Customer records
- Employer records
- Enterprise accounts
- Orders and sales
- Billing calculations
- Validation rules

- Email notifications
- Automated workflows and flows
- Reports
- Dashboards

The system is intended to improve operational efficiency and support better customer relationship management.

8. Key Features Identified During Ideation

Topic: Proposed System Features

The brainstorming stage identified the following important features:

- User login and authentication
- Customer record management
- Employer and enterprise management
- Order management
- Automated billing
- Data validation
- Record types and page layouts
- Global picklists
- Email notifications
- Workflow and Flow automation
- Reports
- Dashboards
- User and role management

9. Ideation Outcome

Topic: Final Idea

The final idea developed from the brainstorming process is to create a **centralized Salesforce CRM application for The Chai Shop & Co.**

The application combines customer management, sales management, automation, reporting, dashboards, and customer communication in a single system.

This idea provides the foundation for the next phase of the project, which is **Requirement Analysis**.

10. Conclusion

Topic: Brainstorming & Ideation Conclusion

The Brainstorming and Ideation Phase helped identify the major problems in customer and sales management and understand the needs of the target users.

After considering manual, Excel-based, and web-based approaches, the project focuses on developing a **Salesforce-based CRM application** for The Chai Shop & Co.

The identified requirements and proposed features provide the foundation for the **Requirement Analysis Phase**.